



BUILT BY AFRICANS
FOR AFRICA

HR TRAINING

MODULE 2

Recruitment and Selection

A Traction Outsourcing Limited HR Training Resource
Student Guide for HR practitioners and hiring teams

BUILT BY AFRICANS, FOR AFRICA

Contents

- 1** Overview on Recruitment and Selection
- 2** Workforce Planning
- 3** Topic 1: Applicable Laws and Regulations Related to Recruitment and Selection
- 4** Topic 2: Job Applicant Databases
- 5** Topic 3: Employment Sources
- 6** Topic 4: Recruitment Methods
- 7** Topic 5: Alternative Staffing Practices
- 8** Topic 6: Interviewing Techniques
- 9** Topic 7: Pre- and Post-Offer Activities
- 10** Topic 8: Orientation and Onboarding
- 11** Review Questions on Module 2

1 Overview on Recruitment and Selection

Recruitment and selection is one of the most important processes in human resources. It is primarily focused on recruiting and hiring more qualified candidates to fill in vacant positions in the company.

Recruitment

is the process of attracting qualified candidates for a job role. It involves identifying potential candidates, generating interest in the job opening, and encouraging applicants to apply.

Selection

is the process of identifying the best candidate from a pool of applicants. It includes evaluating candidates' qualifications, skills and experiences to determine the best fit for the job and the company.

The recruitment and selection process is usually conducted by the HR department. The hiring manager or the head of department in which the job is located participates also in the recruitment and the selection process.

Why is recruitment and selection important?

Recruitment and selection process is important because it helps companies to:

Hire the best talent:

By attracting and selecting the best candidates, companies can improve their overall performance and achieve their goals.

Reduce costs:

The cost of selecting bad candidates can be significant, so it is important to choose the right candidate from the start.

Improve employee morale:

When employees are surrounded by talented and qualified colleagues, they are more likely to be happy and productive.

Promote diversity and Inclusion:

By recruiting and selecting candidates from a diverse range of backgrounds, companies can create a more inclusive and welcoming workplace.

Steps in the recruitment and selection process

The recruitment and selection process typically includes the following steps:

Determine the need:

The first step is to determine the need for a new employee. This may be due to a new position being created, a current employee leaving, or the need to increase team size.

Create a job description (JD):

Once the need for a new employee has been determined, the next step is to create a JD. It explains the main responsibilities and duties of the position, as well as the qualifications and skills required.

Advertising the vacancy:

Once the job description is complete, the next step is to advertise the vacancy. This can be done through a variety of channels, such as job boards, social media, and employee referrals.

Screening candidates:

Once the vacancy is advertised and applications are received, the next step is to screen candidates. This may include reviewing resumes and cover letters, conducting phone interviews, or taking short skills tests.

Conducting interviews:

Once you have screened the pool of candidates, the next step is to conduct interviews. This is an opportunity to learn more about the candidates and assess their suitability for the job and the company.

Make an Offer:

Once the interviews are completed, the next step is to make an offer to the selected candidate. Offer should include salary, benefits, and start date.

Onboarding new employees:

Once the candidates accept the offer, the next step is to onboard them. This includes introducing them to the company, their new team members, and their job duties.

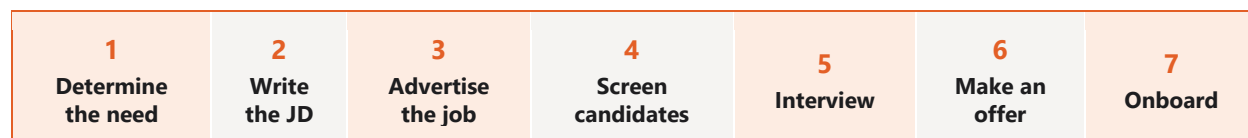


Figure 2.1 General diagram of the recruitment and selection process

Recruitment and selection best practices

Here are some recruitment and selection best practices:

- Be clear and concise in your job description. It should accurately reflect the duties and responsibilities of the position, as well as the qualifications and skills required.
- Use a variety of channels to advertise specific job opportunities to reach all the potential candidates, such as job boards, social media and employee referrals.
- Screen candidates carefully. Proactively interview the first few candidates who apply. Take the time to screen candidates and choose the most qualified people for the job.
- Structure the interviews. Ask all candidates the same questions and use the same criteria to evaluate their answers. This will help ensure that the selection process is fair and objective.
- Get feedback from others: Involve other team members in the interview and selection process. This helps in getting different perspectives on the candidates and choosing the best candidate for the job.

2 Workforce Planning

Workforce planning is a systematic approach to anticipate and prepare for future human resource needs. It includes assessing current staffing levels, forecasting future demand, and developing strategies to address any gaps or surpluses. The ultimate goal of workforce planning is to optimize the workforce to achieve organizational goals and maintain competitive advantage.

What is the importance of workforce planning?

Enhances organizational efficiency:

By aligning staffing levels with demand and ensuring employees have the right skills, workforce planning helps organizations operate more efficiently, leading to increased productivity and cost savings.

Supports strategic goals:

Workforce planning aligns the workforce with the organization's strategic goals, ensuring the right skills and experience are available to achieve long-term goals.

Facilitates smooth transitions:

Workforce planning helps organizations anticipate and prepare for workforce changes, such as retirements, expansions or technological advances, enabling smooth transitions and minimizing disruptions.

Reduces recruitment costs:

By identifying recruitment needs in advance, organizations can plan recruitment activities more effectively, reducing unnecessary costs associated with recruitment via interactive platforms.

Improves employee morale:

A well-planned workforce contributes to a more engaged and motivated workforce. Employees feel valued when their skills and contributions are recognized and used effectively.

Workforce planning process

1. Analyzing the current state of the workforce: This includes assessing the current workforce in terms of skills, experience, demographics, and performance to identify any skills gaps or potential surpluses.

2. Forecasting future workforce needs: This includes factors such as organizational growth, technological advancement, changes in market demand, and attrition rates to anticipate future workforce requirements.
3. Developing workforce strategies: Strategies are developed to address any gaps or surpluses based on anticipated needs. This may include recruitment, training, succession planning, or outsourcing.
4. Implementing and monitoring workforce plans: This focuses on putting strategies into effect and monitoring the workforce on an ongoing basis to ensure compatibility with changing needs and make adjustments as necessary.

Tools and techniques

Many tools and techniques can be used to support workforce planning, including:

Talent Pool:

A database of employees' skills and experience should be maintained to identify potential candidates for promotions or internal transfer.

Succession planning:

Identifying & developing high-potential employees to ensure continuity of leadership and expertise.

Workforce planning programs:

Specialized software can help organizations automate workforce planning tasks, such as forecasting and scenario modeling.

Labor market analysis:

It aims to stay informed of labor market trends, including skills shortages and salary standards, to guide recruitment and training strategies.

Practical example

Acme Technologies, a fast-growing software company, expects significant expansion in the next two years.

They analyzed their current workforce and identified several key findings:

- We need a strong team of software engineers.
- We lack experienced project managers and sales representatives.

- We need workforce that is mostly young with good experience in leadership roles.

Based on its expansion plans, Acme Technologies has projected the following future workforce needs: 20 additional software engineers, 10 experienced project managers, and 15 sales representatives.

To address the identified gaps and surpluses, Acme Technologies developed the following workforce strategies: targeted hiring of experienced project managers and sales representatives, training and development opportunities for current employees to enhance their skills and prepare them for promotions into leadership roles, and succession planning identifying and developing high-potential employees.

By implementing effective workforce planning, Acme Technologies has achieved many benefits: reducing recruitment costs, enhancing productivity, improving employee satisfaction, and achieving strategic goals.

3 Topic 1: Applicable Laws and Regulations Related to Recruitment and Selection

Employers must comply with a variety of laws and regulations when recruiting and selecting employees. These laws vary from country to country, but there are some general principles that apply everywhere.

Work authorization/permits

HR professionals must first verify the legality of all new employees. This involves completing the required forms to verify the employee's eligibility to join the job, such as licenses to practice the profession, visas, permits, etc. Employees must submit documents showing that they are authorized to work in the country.

Job requisition

A job requisition is an internal document that the department requesting an employee submits to HR that identifies the need for a new employee. The requisition must include the following information:

- Workplace (On-site, Remote, or hybrid)
- The department in which the job will be performed
- Essential duties and responsibilities of the job
- Qualifications required for this position
- Salary range (if applicable)

Job postings

A job posting, whether internal or external, is an advertisement used to attract potential candidates for a job. An effective posting must include the information previously mentioned in the job requisition, in addition to the following information:

1. How to apply for the job
2. Duration for applying for the job
3. Brief job description
4. Candidate qualifications and requirements

Anti-discrimination laws

Anti-discrimination laws prohibit employers from discrimination against job applicants or employees on the basis of certain characteristics, such as race, religion, sex, national origin, age, and disability. HR professionals should not ask questions about these characteristics during the interview process or make hiring decisions based on these protected characteristics.

Background checks

Many employers conduct background checks on job applicants before making a hiring decision. These checks can include criminal history checks, educational verification, and reference checks. Employers must have a legitimate reason to conduct background checks, and they must comply with all applicable laws and regulations.

Other applicable laws and regulations

There are a number of other laws and regulations that can impact the recruitment and selection process, depending on the specific industry or location. For example, employers in the United States must comply with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA), which regulates minimum pay, overtime, and child labor. Employers in the European Union must comply with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which protects the privacy of personal data.

Some other laws and regulations that may apply include:

- Minimum salary according to labor law
- Minimum leave in accordance with labor law
- Applicable income tax bracket
- Employing people with special needs and people with disabilities
- Compulsory health insurance
- Confidential data and how to deal with it
- Women's employment laws and regulations

Tips for compliance

- › Company should have a written recruitment & selection policy that define the procedures established to ensures compliance with all prevailing laws.
- › Train all hiring managers and HR professionals on this policy and ensure its compatibility with Anti-discrimination laws.
- › Use clear and concise job postings that avoid discriminatory language.
- › Ask job-related questions only during the interview process, and do not overstep the scope of the job.
- › Conduct background checks in accordance with all applicable laws and regulations.
- › Obtain approval from job applicants before conducting background checks.

Following these tips empowers employers to build a compliant and fair recruitment and selection process that is consistent with all applicable laws and regulations.

Job application: A Guide for Hiring Managers

A job application, a formal document requesting a new hire, is submitted by the department manager to HR for the open position.

The job application must include the following information:

1. The Department
2. Job title
3. Required qualifications
4. Salary range
5. starting date

The job application is an important part of the hiring process because it helps ensure the best fit is hired for the job and the hiring process is fair and compliant with all applicable laws and regulations.

How to write a job application

When writing a job application, it is important to be as specific as possible. The job description must clearly state the duties and responsibilities of the position, as well as the qualifications and experience required. Salary range should be competitive and market-based.

Here are some tips for writing a job application:

- Start by clearly defining your job title and department.
- Write a clear, concise and specific job description.
- Mention the qualifications and experience required for the job.
- Include salary range.
- Indicate the start date of the job.
- Seek the approval of the department manager and HR department on the job application before posting it.

Practical example of a job requisition

Field	Detail
Job title	Software engineer
Department	Engineering
Job description summary	The software engineer will be responsible for designing, developing, and testing software applications. He is required to work closely with the product managers to ensure that the company's software products meet the needs of the customers.
Required qualifications	• Bachelor's degree in computer science or related field • More than 3 years of software development experience • Strong programming skills in Java, Python, or C++ • Experience in object-oriented programming and relational databases • Excellent problem-solving and analysis skills
Salary range	180,000 riyals - 200,000 riyals annually
Starting date	February 1, 2023
Approval of the Manager	Abdullah Abdul Rahman
Human Resources Department	Khaled Ahmed

Once a job application is approved, it can be posted on the company website, job boards and social media platforms. The HR department then begins screening resumes and scheduling interviews.

Job Ads: What are they and how to write an effective one?

A job advertisement is a general announcement of a vacancy in a company. It is usually posted on the company website, job boards, and social media platforms. The purpose of job posting is to attract qualified candidates and encourage them to apply for the job.

A well-written job advertisement should be clear, concise & informative. It must accurately describe duties and responsibilities of the job, as well as the qualifications and experience required. It should also offer a competitive salary and benefits package that aligns with industry.

How to write a job ad

Here are some tips for writing a job ad:

- Start by clearly defining your job title and department.
- Write a clear, concise and specific job description.
- Mention qualifications and experience required for the job.
- Include salary range.
- mention a start date.
- Review the job ad carefully before posting it.

Practical example on the job advertisement

Field	Detail
Function	Software engineer
Department	Engineering
The site	Riyadh, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
Start date	1 May 2024
Job duties	We are looking for a talented and experienced Software Engineer to join our team. As a software engineer, your duty is to design, develop and test software applications. You will work closely with the product managers to ensure that our software products meet the needs of our customers.

Field	Detail
Responsibilities	• Design, develop and test software applications • Work closely with the product managers to ensure that software products meet customer needs • Writing a clear efficient and maintainable code • Debugging and troubleshooting software problems • Participate in code reviews and unit testing • Stay keeping up to date with the latest software development technologies and trends
Qualifications	• Bachelor's degree in computer science or related field • More than 3 years of software development experience • Strong programming skills in Java, Python or C++ • Experience in object-oriented programming and relational databases • Excellent problem-solving and analysis skills
Additional skills	• Experience working on cloud computing platforms • Experience with test-driven development and other agile development practices
To apply	Please send your CV and cover letter to the company's recruitment email address.
Why working with us?	We offer a competitive salary and benefits package, including health, dental, vision insurance, and paid time off. We also have a strong culture of innovation and collaboration, and we are committed to helping our employees grow and develop their careers.

Tips for Effective Job Ads

Here are some tips for writing effective job ads:

1. Use clear and concise language. Avoid using jargon that is prevalent in your company and that candidates from outside the company may not understand.
2. Be specific about job duties and responsibilities. This will help potential candidates determine if the job is a good fit for their skills and experience.
3. Mention the qualifications and experience required. This will help you screen resumes and identify qualified candidates.
4. Include salary range (where applicable). This will help potential candidates determine if the job is a good fit for their financial needs. (This will require a high degree of transparency

internally and externally, so it is recommended to work on this and create an environment for it)

- 5. Indicate the start date of the job. This will help potential candidates plan their job search accordingly.
- 6. Review the job ad carefully before posting it. It is free from typos and grammatical errors.



Figure 2.2 Recruitment and selection process

4 Topic 2: Job Applicant Databases

Applicant databases, also known as candidate databases, are used to store and manage information about job applicants. This information can include the applicant's name, contact information, resume, cover letter, and any other relevant information. Recruiters and hiring managers can use applicant databases to track applicants, screen resumes, schedule interviews, and make hiring decisions.

Benefits of using applicant databases

Improve efficiency:

Applicant databases help HR administrators and hiring managers save time and improve efficiency by automating many of the tasks involved in the hiring process. For example, applicant databases can be used to automatically screen resumes, send rejection emails, and schedule interviews.

Better organization:

Applicant databases help HR administrators and hiring managers track applicants and organize their hiring process. This can help ensure that all applicants are treated fairly and that no one is left out.

Collaboration:

Applicant databases help HR administrators and hiring managers collaborate more effectively. For example, recruiters can use applicant databases to share resumes with hiring managers and track the status of applications.

Compliance:

Applicant databases help employers comply with all applicable laws and regulations. For example, they are used to track the diversity of the applicant pool and ensure fair treatment for all.

How to choose an applicant database

When choosing an applicant database, it is important to consider the following factors:

Features:

Make sure your applicant database has all the features you need, such as resume scanning, interview scheduling, and reporting.

Ease of use:

The database should be easy to use for both HR administrators and hiring managers.

Scalability:

Your applicant database should be scalable to meet your needs as your company grows.

Safety:

The applicant database must be safe and protect the privacy of the applicant's data.

Tips for using applicant databases

Here are some tips for using applicant databases effectively:

Keep the database updated:

Ensure the applicant database is regularly updated with new applications and updates the existing applications.

Use the database to scan resumes:

Applicant databases can be used to automatically scan resumes for keywords and other criteria. This can help you save time and identify the most qualified candidates.

Use the database to schedule interviews:

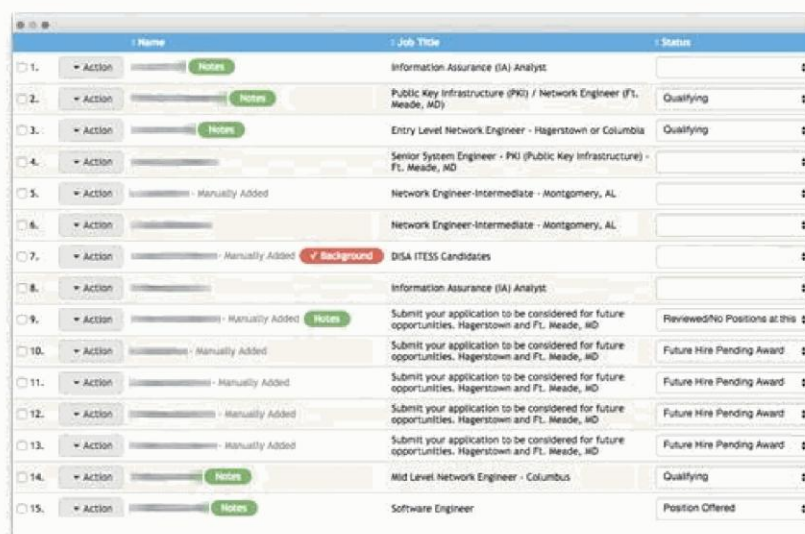
Applicant databases can be used to schedule interviews with candidates. This can help save time and streamline the hiring process.

Use database to track the applicant's path:

Applicant databases can be used to track the status of each application. This can help you determine where candidates stand in the hiring process and ensure that all applicants are treated fairly.

Use the database to create reports

Applicant databases can be used to generate reports about the applicant pool and hiring process. This information can be used to make better hiring decisions and improve the hiring process over time.



	Name	Job Title	Status
1.	[Action] [Notes]	Information Assurance (IA) Analyst	
2.	[Action] [Notes]	Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) / Network Engineer (Ft. Meade, MD)	Qualifying
3.	[Action] [Notes]	Entry Level Network Engineer - Hagerstown or Columbia	Qualifying
4.	[Action]	Senior System Engineer - PKI (Public Key Infrastructure) - Ft. Meade, MD	
5.	[Action] - Manually Added	Network Engineer-Intermediate - Montgomery, AL	
6.	[Action]	Network Engineer-Intermediate - Montgomery, AL	
7.	[Action] - Manually Added ✓ Background	DISA ITSS Candidates	
8.	[Action]	Information Assurance (IA) Analyst	
9.	[Action] - Manually Added [Notes]	Submit your application to be considered for future opportunities. Hagerstown and Ft. Meade, MD	Reviewed/No Positions at this
10.	[Action] - Manually Added	Submit your application to be considered for future opportunities. Hagerstown and Ft. Meade, MD	Future Hire Pending Award
11.	[Action] - Manually Added	Submit your application to be considered for future opportunities. Hagerstown and Ft. Meade, MD	Future Hire Pending Award
12.	[Action] - Manually Added	Submit your application to be considered for future opportunities. Hagerstown and Ft. Meade, MD	Future Hire Pending Award
13.	[Action] - Manually Added	Submit your application to be considered for future opportunities. Hagerstown and Ft. Meade, MD	Future Hire Pending Award
14.	[Action] [Notes]	Mid Level Network Engineer - Columbus	Qualifying
15.	[Action] [Notes]	Software Engineer	Position Offered

Figure 2.3 A sample of the applicant database format

The impact of artificial intelligence on recruitment processes

Artificial intelligence (AI) is rapidly changing the world, and the hiring process is no exception. AI-powered tools are being used to automate tasks, improve efficiency, and make better hiring decisions.

One of the most popular ways to use AI in recruiting is to automate tasks. AI-powered applicant tracking systems (ATS) can scan resumes and employment letters for keywords, identify potential candidates, and schedule interviews. This can save new hires a significant amount of time, and can help ensure that qualified candidates are not overlooked.

Artificial intelligence is also being used to improve the efficiency of the recruitment process. For example, AI-powered chatbots can answer candidates' questions, schedule interviews, and provide updates about the hiring process. This can lead HR leaders to focus more on more strategic tasks, such as building relationships with candidates and hiring managers.

In addition to automating tasks and improving efficiency, AI is also being used to make better hiring decisions. For example, AI-powered tools can analyze resumes and cover letters to identify candidates by analyzing the skills and experience needed for a particular role. The Internet can also be used to conduct video interviews, which can help recruiters get a better idea of a candidate's personality and how they fit into the company culture. Overall, AI has a significant impact on the hiring process. By automating tasks, improving efficiency, and making better hiring decisions, AI helps make the hiring process more effective and efficient.

Although there are many benefits to using AI in recruiting, there are also some challenges that need to be addressed. One of the biggest challenges is that AI can be used to discriminate against certain groups of candidates such as women and people with disabilities. It is important to ensure that AI-powered tools are used in a fair and unbiased manner.

Another challenge is the need for training and education. HR administrators and hiring managers need to be trained on how to use AI-powered tools effectively. They should also be aware of potential risks associated with AI, such as the potential for bias.

Overall, AI is a powerful tool that can be used to improve the hiring process. However, it is important to use AI responsibly and ethically.

Impact of Big Data on Recruitment and Selection

Big data is the collection and analysis of large data sets to reveal patterns and trends that may be difficult or impossible to see using smaller data sets. Big data has had a huge impact on the way companies recruit and select employees.

Here are some of the ways in which Big Data is being used in recruitment and selection:

Identifying qualified candidates:

Big data can be used to identify qualified candidates from a variety of sources, including social media, job boards, and professional databases. For example, companies can use big data to identify candidates who have the skills and experience required for the job, or who have worked at similar companies in the past.

Screening CVs:

Big data can be used to screen CVs more efficiently and effectively. For example, companies can use big data to identify resumes that contain keywords and phrases relevant to the job opening.

Predicting the performance of new employees:

Big data can be used to predict the performance of new employees. For example, companies can use big data to identify factors associated with high performance, such as educational background, work experience, and personality traits.

Improving employee experience:

Big data can be used to improve employee experience during the recruitment and selection process. For example, companies can use big data to identify and address any process weaknesses, such as long wait times or repetitive tasks.

Here are some of the benefits of using Big Data in recruitment and selection:

Reducing the required time for recruitment:

Big data can help companies reduce the time it takes to hire new employees. For example, companies can use big data to identify qualified candidates more quickly and screen resumes more efficiently.

Improving the quality of employees' performance:

Big data can help companies improve the quality of their employees' performance. For example, companies can use big data to identify candidates who are best suited for a job and who are most likely to succeed.

Reducing costs:

Big data can help companies reduce recruitment and selection costs. For example, companies can use big data to automate tasks and identify and address any inefficiencies in the process.

Increase diversity:

Big data can help companies increase the diversity of their workforce. For example, companies can use big data to identify qualified candidates from underrepresented groups.

Overall, big data is a powerful tool that can be used to improve the recruitment and selection process. By using big data, companies can reduce the time it takes to hire new employees, improve the quality of their hires, reduce costs, and increase the diversity of their workforce.

Practical examples of how companies use Big Data in recruitment and selection

1. A large global retail company uses big data to identify and hire qualified candidates from a variety of sources, including social media, job boards, and professional databases. It also uses big data to scan resumes and predict the performance of new employees.
2. A large global technology company uses big data to identify and hire qualified candidates from all over the world. It also uses big data to improve the employee experience during the recruitment and selection process.
3. A large global technology company uses big data to improve the diversity of its workforce. It uses big data to identify qualified candidates from underrepresented groups.

Big data is still a relatively new technology, but it is already having a major impact on the way companies recruit and select employees. As big data technology continues to evolve, we can expect to see more innovative and effective ways to use big data in recruitment and selection.

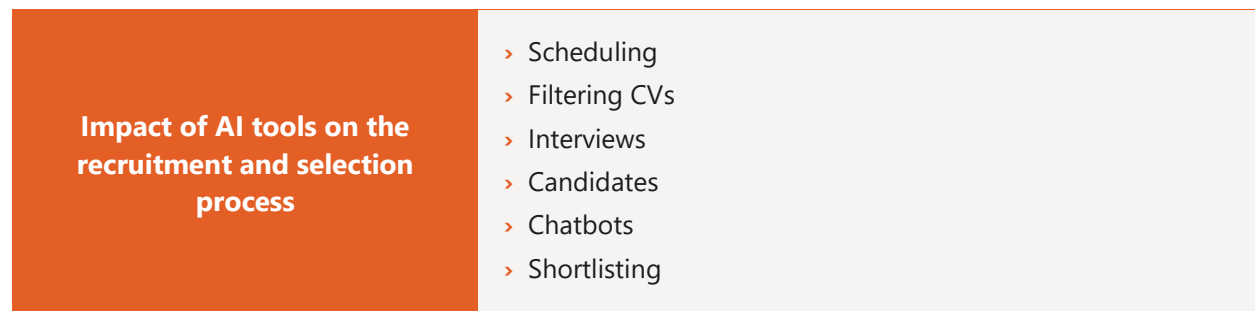


Figure 2.4 The impact of artificial intelligence tools on the recruitment and selection process

Review questions

Q1. What is one way in which Big Data is used in recruitment and selection?

- A. Identify qualified candidates
- B. Resume examination
- C. Predicting the performance of new employees
- D. All of the above

Q2. What's the best way to avoid attracting unqualified candidates for a job?

- A. Be vague about job duties and responsibilities
- B. State the required qualifications in detail
- C. Use jargon and technical terms in the job posting
- D. Set the salary range too low

Q3. What information should a job advertisement include?

- A. Job title, department, job description, required qualifications, salary range, and start date
- B. Job title, department, manager contact information, and budget
- C. Job title, department, job description and required qualifications
- D. Job title, department and start date

Q4. Which of the following laws prohibits employers from discriminating against job applicants or employees on the basis of certain characteristics such as race, religion, sex, national origin, age, and disability?

- A. Anti-discrimination laws
- B. Employment Standards Act
- C. General Data Protection Regulation
- D. Fair Labor Standards Act

Q5. What are some factors to consider when choosing an applicant database?

- A. Ease of use
- B. Scalability
- C. Safety
- D. All of the above

Answers: 1. D 2. B 3. A 4. A 5. D

5 Topic 3: Employment Sources

When it comes to hiring new employees, there are 2 main methods: internal recruitment and external recruitment. Internal recruiting involves searching for candidates within the company, while external recruiting involves searching for candidates outside the company.

Internal Recruitment

Internal hiring has several key benefits:

Cost-effective method to hire new employees.

When you are hiring from within, you avoid paying recruitment fees, or transportation costs.

Internal recruitment boosts employee morale.

When employees see their recognition through promotions and new opportunities, it elevates their engagement and production.

Internal hiring helps retain the best talent.

When employees are aware of opportunities for advancement within company, they are more likely to stay and contribute their valuable skills.

External Recruitment

Outsourcing is often a good option for hiring new employees because:

It gives access to a wider pool of candidates.

When you hire externally, you're not limited to people who already work at your company. This is especially useful if you are looking for candidates with specialized skills or experience.

External hiring helps bring new ideas and perspectives to your company.

When you bring in new employees from different backgrounds and experiences, they can bring with them new ways of thinking and new solutions to old problems.

Choose the right method

The best hiring method will vary depending on the specific needs of your company. If you are looking for a cost-effective way to hire new employees and want to boost employee's morale, internal hiring may be a good option. If you are looking for candidates with specialized skills or experience, or want to bring new ideas and perspectives to your company, external recruitment may be a good option.

Beyond the basics: Choosing your hiring method

The size of your company.

If you have a small company, it may be more practical to find qualified candidates within your existing workforce. If you have a larger organization, it can be difficult to find suitable candidates internally.

The type of job you want to hire.

Some positions are often filled internally, such as entry-level positions. However, other positions, such as senior positions, are more likely to be filled from outside.

Hiring budget.

If you have a limited budget, you may want to focus on internal recruiting. However, if you have greater financial resources, you may be able to afford outside hiring.

Ultimately, the best way to decide whether to hire internally or externally is to weigh the pros and cons of each approach and choose the best strategy for your company.

Recruitment Metrics

These metrics are key performance indicators (KPIs) that measure the effectiveness of a company's recruitment process. They can be used to track progress over time, identify areas for improvement, and make informed decisions about hiring strategies.

Some of the most common hiring metrics include:

1. Time to hire: The time it takes to fill an open position, from the moment the job is posted until the new hire starts working.
2. Cost per hire: The total cost of hiring a candidate, including advertising costs, screening, interviewing, and onboarding costs.
3. Yield Ratio: The percentage of candidates who move from one stage of the hiring process to the next.
4. Quality of hire: New employee performance and job satisfaction, which is reflected in the performance of the organization as a whole

Time to hire

Time to hire is an important metric, because it can impact a company's productivity and bottom line. Excessive time to hire can result in lost revenue, increase costs and decrease employee morale.

There are a number of factors that can affect time to hire, such as the complexity of the required skills and experience, the size and quality of the applicant pool, and the efficiency of the hiring process. Companies can reduce the time they spend hiring by simplifying recruitment procedures, and setting clear timelines and adhering to them on the hiring process.

Cost per hire

It is another important metric because it can accurately forecast and optimize their recruitment budget for hiring and track their spending. The cost of hiring can vary depending on the type of role being recruited for, and the recruitment methods used.

Companies can reduce the cost of hiring by using cost-effective recruitment methods, such as employee referrals and social media recruitment. They can also negotiate lower fees with recruitment agencies and other service providers.

Yield Ratio

It is a measure of the efficiency of recruitment process. It is calculated by dividing the number of candidates who move from one stage of the hiring process to the next by the total number of candidates who begin the process.

A high yield ratio indicates that the hiring process is efficient and that the company is able to attract and qualify candidates. A low yield ratio potentially suggests that the hiring process is too complicated or that the company is not attracting suitable candidates.

Quality of hire

It is the most important hiring metric, but also the most difficult to measure. It is typically measured by tracking the performance and satisfaction of new employees over time.

Some common indicators of hiring quality include:

New employee turnover rate:

The percentage of new employees who leave the company during a given period of time.

New employee Productivity:

The performance of new hires compared to their peers.

New employee satisfaction:

New employees' level of satisfaction with their jobs and with the company.

Companies can increase the efficiency of their human resources by using effective selection methods, providing new employees with appropriate training and support, and creating a positive work environment.

Recruitment metrics can be used to improve the hiring process by:

Identify potential areas for optimization:

By tracking hiring metrics over time, companies can identify areas where the hiring process is ineffective.

Make informed decisions about hiring strategies:

These metrics can be used to evaluate the effectiveness of different recruitment strategies and make informed decisions about how to allocate resources.

Demonstrate the value of the hiring process:

These metrics can be used to demonstrate the value of the hiring process to the stakeholders within the organization.

By using recruiting metrics effectively, companies can improve recruiting process & attract and hire the best possible candidates.

Stage	Candidates	Conversion
Applications	250	—
Phone screening	50	20%
1st interview round	25	50%
Case studies	15	60%
Interview with executive team	5	33%
Offers	2	40%

Figure 2.5 Yield Ratio pyramid (overall yield ratio: 0.8%)

6 Topic 4: Recruitment Methods

Recruitment methods are the processes that employers use to identify, attract and hire qualified candidates for open jobs. There are a variety of recruitment methods available, and the best approach for an employer will depend on the specific needs of the company and the type of role they are recruiting for.

There are many different recruitment methods, both internal and external. Some of the most common sources include:

1. **Employee referrals:** Employees are often a valuable source of nominations for new hires. They know the company and culture, and can attest to the skills and abilities of their friends and colleagues.
2. **Social media:** Social media platforms can be an effective way to connect with potential candidates. You can post job openings, promote your company culture, and engage with prospective talent professionally.
3. **Company's Website:** A company website is a powerful place to post job opportunities and provide information about your company. You can also use the company's website to collect resumes of potential candidates.
4. **Recruitment agencies:** Recruitment agencies can help you find qualified candidates for your open positions. They have access to a large pool of candidates, and can help you screen and interview candidates.
5. **Recruitment forums:** Recruitment forums are a valuable way to reach a large number of potential candidates. You can post your job openings on a variety of forums, and you can target your ads to specific candidate categories.
6. **College Events:** College events are an effective place to find entry-level candidates. You can attend job fairs, post job openings on campus, and even hire students directly.
7. **Industry events:** Industry events are a valuable way to network with potential candidates and learn about the latest trends in your industry. You can also use these events to promote your company and its open locations.

The suitable way to find the right recruiting sources for your company will depend on your specific needs and budget. Using a variety of sources can increase your chances of finding the best-suited candidates for your open positions.

Comparing recruitment sources

Recruitment source	Positives	Negatives
Employee referrals	• High quality candidates • Fit the company culture • Faster hiring process • Cost-effective	• It can lead to bias • It does not attract a diverse group of candidates • Administration can take a long time
Social networks/social media	• A large group of candidates • Reach a diverse audience • Cost effective • Easy to use	• It is difficult to verify candidate information • It can create negative employer branding if used poorly
The company's website	• Control the recruitment process • Company culture and benefits can be showcased • Cost-effective	• Limited access • It does not attract all qualified candidates • The update can take a long time

Ultimately, the suitable way to recruit new employees will depend on the specific needs of your company. If you are looking for a cost-effective way to reach a wide audience, social media recruitment can be a valuable option. If you are looking for candidates who are familiar with your company and its culture, employee nominations are the way to go. If you need to fill a senior position quickly or need access to a large pool of candidates, recruitment agencies are the best choice for you.

Additional tips for effective recruiting

- Make sure your job advertisements are clear and concise. Potential candidates should be able to quickly understand what the job entails and the qualifications required.
- Use keywords relevant to the position. This will help your job ads appear in search results when candidates search for jobs.
- Post job opportunities in different places. The more places you post job openings, the more potential candidates you'll reach.
- Make sure your website is updated and has the necessary information. Potential candidates should be able to learn more about your company and its culture on your website.
- Connect with candidates quickly. Candidates should hear from you within a reasonable time after applying for a job.

- Be prepared to answer questions. Potential candidates will likely have questions about the job, the company, and the benefits. Be prepared to answer these questions honestly and accurately.

Sources of Recruitment

Internal	External
• Promotion • Transfers • Upgrading • Demotion • Retired Employees • Retrenched Employees	• Advertisements • Campus Recruitment • Placement Agencies • Outsourcing/Consultancies • Employment Exchanges • Labor Contractors

Figure 2.6 Sources of Recruitment

Review questions

Q1. Which of the following is not a measure of employment?

- A. Time to hire
- B. Employee engagement
- C. Cost per hire
- D. Yield ratio

Q2. Which of the following is advice for using employee referrals as an effective recruiting source?

- A. Encourage employees to nominate their friends and family members by offering incentives.
- B. Make it easier for employees to submit nominations by creating a formal nomination program.
- C. Both (a) and (b)
- D. None of the above

Q3. Which of the following is a negative aspect of a company's website as a recruitment source?

- A. Difficulty controlling the recruitment process
- B. Difficulty presenting company culture
- C. Cost Increase

D. Limited access

Q4. Which of the following recruitment sources best matches a company with a young, tech-savvy workforce?

- A. Employee nominations
- B. Social networks/social media
- C. Company website
- D. Recruitment agencies

Q5. Which of the following is disadvantage of employee referral as recruitment source?

- A. It can lead to bias
- B. Lower quality candidates
- C. Not a good fit for the company culture
- D. Slow hiring process

Answers: 1. B 2. C 3. D 4. B 5. A

7 Topic 5: Alternative Staffing Practices

Traditional hiring practices are the most common method to find and hire the best employees. In today's competitive job market, companies are increasingly turning to alternative staffing practices to fill open positions.

These practices are any methods of hiring employees that differ from the traditional "full-time, permanent" model. It can include:

Recruitment Process Outsource (RPO)

A type of alternative staffing practice in which an employer outsources some or all of its recruiting and staffing process to an outside party. RPO providers can provide a range of services, including posting jobs, screening resumes, conducting interviews, and making hiring recommendations.

Advantages of recruitment process outsource services

Reduce costs:

RPO providers can often save employers costs, as they have the experience and resources to streamline the hiring process.

Increased efficiency:

RPO providers can help employers hire more quickly and efficiently, by taking care of all the administrative tasks associated with hiring.

Access to a larger talent pool:

Agencies can have access to a larger talent pool than employers who access to diverse sourcing channels. This is because they have a network of candidates and can also post jobs on a variety of job boards and other websites.

Job Sharing

Job sharing is a type of alternative employment practice where two or more employees share one full-time job. Job-sharing employees typically work part-time and divide job responsibilities equally.

Advantages of job sharing

1. Reducing costs: Job sharing can help employers reduce labor costs, as they only pay two part-time wage employees for one full-time job.

2. Increased flexibility: Job sharing can help employers be more flexible with their staffing needs. For example, they can use job sharing to cover peak periods or to provide coverage for employees who are on vacation or sick leave.
3. Improve employee morale: Job sharing can help improve employee morale, as it allows employees to achieve a better work-life balance.

Remote Workers

Remote workers are employees who work from a location other than their employer's office. Remote work can be full-time, part-time, or casual.

Advantages of working remotely

Reduce costs:

Remote workers typically incur lower overhead costs than office-based employees. For example, employers do not need to provide office space or equipment for remote workers.

Increased flexibility:

Remote work can help employers be more flexible with their staffing needs. For example, they can hire remote workers from all over the world, regardless of location.

Access to a wider pool of talent:

Remote work can help employers access a wider pool of talent, as it is not limited to candidates who live close to their offices.

Other Alternative Staffing Practices

Alternative staffing practices may also include:

Freelance:

Freelancers are self-employed individuals who contract out their services to clients on a project-by-project basis.

Contract work:

Contract workers are appointed for a specific period of time to work on a specific project.

Temp-to-hire:

Temp-to-hire workers are temporary workers who are hired with the possibility of converting to permanent employees.

How can an organization choose the best alternative staffing practices?

There are many alternative hiring practices that an organization can choose from. Best practices for a given organization depend on its specific needs and goals.

Some factors to consider when choosing an alternative staffing practice include:

1. The type of work to be done: Some alternative staffing practices are better suited to certain types of work than others. For example, remote work may be a good option for jobs that can be done independently, while job sharing may be a good option for jobs that require a team of people.
2. Organization's budget: Some alternative staffing practices may be more expensive than others. For example, an RPO can be a more expensive option than internal recruitment.
3. Organization culture: Some alternative staffing practices may be better suited to certain organizational cultures than others. For example, remote work may be a better fit for organizations that value flexibility and collaboration, while job sharing may be a better fit for organizations that value teamwork and communication.

Once an organization considers these factors, it can begin to narrow down its options and choose the suitable alternative staffing practice for its needs.

Here are some additional tips for choosing alternative staffing best practices:

Do your research.

There is a lot of information available about alternative staffing practices. Take some time to research the different options and learn about their advantages and disadvantages.

Talk to your employees.

Get input from your employees about their preferences for alternative staffing practices. They may have valuable insights that you haven't considered.

Be flexible.

The best alternative staffing practices may change over time. Be prepared to adapt your practices as needed.

Criteria of Comparison	Recruitment Process Outsourcing (RPO)	Job Sharing	Remote working
Definition	A service in which a company hires an outside company to manage all or part of its recruiting process.	An arrangement in which two or more people share the responsibilities of one full-time job.	Employees who work from home or elsewhere outside the company office.
Benefits	• Access to a wide range of talent • Free up internal resources to focus on other tasks.	• Reducing labor costs. • Attract and retain employees who want more flexibility • Improving work-life balance.	• Save money on office space. • Attract and retain employees who want more flexibility. • Improve productivity.
Challenges	• Can be expensive • May not be suitable for all companies or positions. • It can be difficult to manage the relationship with an outside company.	• It may be difficult to find two or more people who are a good fit for the job and each other. • It can be difficult to coordinate schedules and responsibilities.	• It can be difficult to maintain a sense of community and collaboration among remote workers. • It can be difficult to ensure that remote workers have the resources they need to succeed.
When is it preferable to use?	• When you need to hire a large number of employees quickly. • When you need to employ employees with specialized skills or experience. • When you do not have the resources to manage your own recruitment process.	• When you need to reduce your labor costs. • When you need to attract and retain employees who want more flexibility. • When you need to improve your work-life balance.	• When you need to save money on office space. • When you need to attract and retain employees who want more flexibility. • When you need to improve productivity.

8 Topic 6: Interviewing Techniques

There are many different interview techniques that can be used to evaluate job candidates. Some of the most common techniques include:

Structured Interviews:

These interviews use a set of pre-defined questions that are asked to all candidates. This technique of interview is often used to evaluate candidates' skills, knowledge, and experience.

Unstructured Interviews:

These are considered less formal as they allow different questions to be asked to each job candidate. This technique of interview can be used to get a better sense of the candidate's personality and fit into the company culture.

Behavioral Interviews:

Within these interviews, candidates are asked to describe their previous behavior in specific situations. This technique of interview can be used to evaluate a candidate's skills and experience and how he or she would handle certain situations on the job, based on his or her behavior in previous situations.

Situational Interviews:

Within these interviews, the interviewers tell the candidates a hypothetical situation and ask them how they would deal with it. This technique of interview can be used to evaluate a candidate's problem-solving skills and decision-making ability.

Panel/Group Interviews:

These interviews include several interviewers asking the candidate questions. This type of interview can be used to get a variety of perspectives on the candidates and assess their ability to deal with several people at once.

The best technique to conduct interviews in each case depends on a number of factors, including job requirements, company culture, and the interviewer's experience. However, all of these techniques can be effective in evaluating job candidates and making hiring decisions.

Tips for conducting effective interviews

1. Be ready: Do your research on the candidate and the job before the interview. This will help you ask more informed questions and leave a better impression.

2. Be professional: Dress appropriately, arrive on time, and be courteous and respectful throughout the interview.
3. Be a good listener: Pay attention to what the candidate says and ask clarifying questions.
4. Be objective: Don't let biases or personal preferences influence your decision.
5. Stay tuned: Send the candidate a thank you note after the interview and let them know when you expect to make a decision.

By following these tips, you can conduct effective interviews that will help you hire the best candidates for job openings.

Structured versus unstructured interviews

There are 2 main techniques of interviews: Structured and Unstructured Interviews. Structured interviews are more formal and use a set of pre-determined questions that are asked to all candidates. Unstructured interviews are considered less formal and allow the interviewer to ask questions specific to the candidate and the job.

Structured interviews

Structured interviews are often used to evaluate candidates' skills, knowledge, and experience. They are also used to ensure all candidates are assessed fairly and consistently. These interviews are usually conducted by a panel of interviewers, each of whom asks the same questions to all candidates. This helps ensure that all candidates have a fair opportunity to demonstrate their skills and abilities.

Unstructured interviews

Unstructured interviews are informal and allow the interviewer to ask questions specific to the candidate and the job. This technique of interview can be used to get a better sense of the candidate's personality and fit into the company culture. Unstructured interviews are usually conducted by an interviewer, who may ask different questions to different candidates. This can make it difficult to compare candidates and make hiring decisions.

It depends on a number of factors, including job requirements and the company's culture and preferences. If the company is looking for a fair and consistent method to evaluate candidates, a structured interview may be the suitable option for it. If it is looking for an informal interview that allows you to get to know the candidate better, an unstructured interview may be the optimal option.

Interview type	Pros	Cons
Structured interviews	• Fair and consistent • It is easy to compare candidates • It can be used to assess a wide range of skills and abilities	• It can be more formal and intimidating for candidates • It can take longer to implement
Unstructured interviews	• Informal and quiet • Allows you to get to know the candidate better • It can be used to evaluate personal skills and their fit with the company culture	• Less fair and consistent • It is difficult to compare candidates • It can take longer to implement

Ultimately, the right method to choose the optimal technique of interview is to consider the company's needs and preferences.

Behavioral Interview

Behavioral interviews are a type of interview that asks candidates to describe their past behavior in specific situations. This technique of interview is often used to evaluate a candidate's skills, experience, and how they would handle certain situations on the job.

Behavioral interview questions typically begin with "Tell me about a time...". For example, "Tell me about a time you faced a conflict with a teammate and how you resolved it." The interviewer is looking for specific examples of how the candidate has dealt with similar situations in the past.

Here are some tips for answering behavioral interview questions:

Use the STAR Model: The STAR model is a useful form for organizing behavioral interview questions. It is an abbreviation for:

- Situation: Describe the situation you were in.
- Task: What is your task or goal in this case?
- Application: What did you do?
- Result: What was the result of your actions?

Behavioral interviews can be a valuable tool for evaluating job candidates. By asking candidates to describe their past behavior, interviewers can get a better understanding of their skills and experience and how they would handle certain situations on the job.

Situational Interview

It is a technique of interview in which the interviewer presents the candidate with a hypothetical situation and asks him how he would handle it. This technique is often used to evaluate a candidate's problem-solving skills, decision-making ability, and critical thinking skills.

Situational interview questions typically begin with the phrase, "What would you do if...". For example: "Imagine you're managing a project facing unforeseen delays. How would you ensure timely completion while maintaining team morale?"

Here are more examples of situational interview questions:

- What would you do if you had a very upset customer?
- How would you handle a situation where you had to work under a tight deadline?
- What would you do if you had a dispute with a coworker?
- How would you handle a situation where you had to make a difficult decision?

Panel/group interview

A job interview in which a group of people, usually two or more people, are interviewed. The committee includes the hiring manager, a representative from HR, and other team members as additional members. Group interviews are becoming increasingly popular, because they allow employers to get input from multiple people before making a hiring decision.

Online Interviews

Online interviews are becoming increasingly popular, as they offer a number of advantages for both employers and candidates. For employers, online interviews can save time and money, as they can be conducted from anywhere with an internet connection. It can also be a more convenient option for candidates, as it can be conducted from the comfort of their homes.

However, there are also some challenges associated with online interviews. One of the biggest challenges is that it can be difficult to assess a candidate's skills and abilities when you can't see them in person. Additionally, online interviews can be more prone to technical difficulties, which can disrupt the flow of the interview.

Here are some tips for successful online interviews:

Choose the appropriate platform.

There are a number of different video-conferencing platforms that can be used to conduct online interviews, so it is important to choose a platform that is reliable and easy to use.

Test your equipment.

Before the interview, make sure that your computer, microphone, and camera are working properly. You should also test your internet connection to make sure it is strong enough to support a video call.

Create a professional environment.

Even though you are interviewing from home, it is important to create a professional environment. This means finding a quiet place for the interview where you will not be interrupted. You should also dress professionally, as if you were attending a traditional in-person interview.

Commit to the start and end times of the interview.

Punctuality is important in any interview, but it's especially important for online interviews. This is because candidates may be bound by other commitments, such as childcare or work, so they will appreciate it if you start and finish the interview on time.

Be ready.

Just like any other interview, it's important to be prepared for your online interview. This means researching the company and position, as well as practicing your answers to common interview questions.

By following these tips, you can conduct successful online interviews that will help you find the best candidates for job openings.

On the other hand, one of the biggest challenges of online interviews is that it can be difficult to maintain engagement. This is because you are unable to see the candidate's body language. To counter this, be sure to make eye contact with the candidate and ask open-ended questions that require more than a one-word answer. After the interview, be sure to send the candidate a thank you note. This personalized message can go a long way in expressing appreciation for the candidate's time, reiterating key points discussed, and providing next steps demonstrates professionalism and genuine interest.

1	2	3	4	5
Structured Interviews	Unstructured Interviews	Behavioral Interviews	Situational Interviews	Panel/Group Interviews

Figure 2.7 Main techniques of personal interviews

Pre-employment tests

When hiring a new employee, it is important to use a variety of tools to evaluate candidates. This includes reviewing their resumes, conducting interviews, and tests. Tests can be a valuable way to assess a candidate's skills, knowledge, and abilities.

There are many different types of tests that can be used in the hiring process. Some of the most common types include:

1. Job Knowledge tests: These tests measure the candidate's knowledge of the skills and tasks required for the job.
2. Skills Test: These tests measure a candidate's ability to perform specific tasks, such as writing, using programs, or operating machinery.
3. Cognitive Abilities tests: These tests measure the candidate's general intelligence, problem-solving skills, and thinking ability.
4. Personality tests: These tests measure the candidate's personality traits, such as their level of introversion or extroversion, their conscientiousness, and their agreeableness.
5. Integrity Tests: These tests measure the honesty and trustworthiness of candidate.

When choosing which tests to use, it is important to consider the specific requirements of the job. For example, if the job requires a high level of technical expertise, a skills test may be a good option. If the job requires a high level of customer interaction, a personality test may be a more suitable option.

It is also important to ensure that tests are fair and unbiased. Tests must not discriminate against any group of people, for example due to race, gender, or age.

When used correctly, tests can be a valuable tool in the staffing process. They can help identify the highly-qualified candidates for the job and ensure that all candidates are evaluated fairly.

Here are some additional tips for using tests in the staffing process:

- Use a variety of tests to get a comprehensive view of the candidate.
- Administer tests in a consistent and fair manner.
- Use test results along with other factors, such as an interview, to make a hiring decision.

Types of pre-employment tests

- › Cognitive Aptitude
- › Emotional Intelligence
- › Technical Tests
- › Personality Tests
- › Integrity Tests

Figure 2.8 Types of pre-employment tests

Review questions

Q1. What is the main advantage of alternative staffing practices for employers?

- A. Reduce costs
 - B. Increase flexibility
 - C. Access to a broader pool of talent
 - D. All of the above
-

Q2. Which of the following is not an example of an alternative staffing practice?

- A. Recruitment Process Outsourcing (RPO)
 - B. Full-time and permanent employment
 - C. Job sharing
 - D. Remote work
-

Q3. Which of the following alternative staffing practices is most appropriate for a company that needs to employ skilled workers located throughout the world?

- A. Recruitment Process Outsourcing (RPO)
 - B. Job sharing
 - C. Remote work
 - D. Temporary workers until hired
-

Q4. Which of the following interviewing techniques is most appropriate for assessing a candidate's problem-solving skills?

- A. Situational interview
 - B. Structured interview
 - C. Unstructured interview
 - D. Behavioral interview
-

Q5. Which of the following is a good way to avoid interviewer bias?

- A. Be aware of your biases and try to mitigate them
 - B. Use structured interviews and standardized scoring criteria
 - C. Ask open-ended questions that allow all candidates to demonstrate their skills and qualifications
 - D. All of the above
-

Q6. What are some of the benefits of using pre-employment tests?

- A. Improve hiring decisions
-

- B.** Reduce costs
- C.** Increase productivity
- D.** All of the above

Answers: 1. D 2. B 3. C 4. A 5. D 6. D

9 Topic 7: Pre- and Post-Offer Activities

The hiring process is a complex and time-consuming process, but it is important to get it right. The first step is to find qualified candidates, then carefully screen them before making a job offer. Once an offer is made, there are a few more steps to take before the new employee begins his or her job.

Pre-job offer activities

These are the steps employers take to screen and evaluate potential candidates before making a job offer. These activities usually include:

Job posting and review of applications:

Employers post job opportunities on their websites and other job boards, and then review the applications they receive to identify qualified candidates.

Phone screening:

Employers conduct short telephone interviews with qualified candidates to learn more about their experience and skills, and to evaluate their suitability for the position.

Personal interviews:

Employers invite the most qualified candidates to conduct personal interviews, which provide an opportunity to learn more about their skills and experiences, and assess their cultural suitability.

Reference Checking:

Employers contact references provided by candidates to verify their experience and skills, and to obtain feedback about their work performance and personality.

Pre-employment screenings:

Employers can also conduct pre-employment screenings, such as background checks, drug tests, and medical examinations.

Post-job offer activities

These are the steps employers take after making a job offer to a candidate, but before the candidate starts working. These activities usually include:

1. **Job Offer Letter:** The employer sends the candidate a written offer letter stating the terms of employment, such as job title, salary, benefits, and start date.

2. **Reference Checking:** It differs from reference checking in pre-job offer activities, as the employer conducts a background check on the candidate to verify his identity and his criminal, credit, and tax record.
3. **Medical Checking:** The employer may also ask the candidate to undergo a medical examination, to ensure that he is physically and mentally capable of performing the job duties.
4. **New hire paperwork:** The candidate completes new hire paperwork, such as tax forms, health insurance forms, and other required documents.
5. **Orientation & Onboarding:** The employer provides the new employee with the necessary technical training and information about the company, its vision, and culture. The new employee is also introduced to the job and the work team.

By following these steps, you can ensure that you are hiring the highly qualified candidates and providing them with a positive and comprehensive onboarding experience. This will help them keep up to date quickly and easily, and feel welcome and appreciated. This will also help the company build a strong team and create a productive workplace.

Post-offer activities are important for a number of reasons.

- They help employers identify and hire the best candidates for their jobs.
- It helps employers comply with applicable laws and regulations.
- It helps employers protect their employees, customers and other stakeholders.

Here are some additional tips for employers regarding pre-offer and post-offer activities:

- Ensure that pre-offer activities are fair and consistent. All candidates must undergo the same screening and evaluation process.
- Be transparent with candidates about the pre-offer activities you will conduct. Disclose this information in your job advertisements and offer letters.
- Obtain the candidate's approval before conducting any pre-offer screening or research.
- Comply with all applicable laws and regulations regarding pre-employment screenings.

1 Preparing

- Vacancy intake w. hiring manager
- Write job description
- Create job advert

2 Sourcing

- Source candidates
- Check existing talent pool

3 Screening

- Screen resumes
- Phone screening
- Give realistic job preview

4 Selecting – Close contact with the hiring manager – Use an interview guide to structure the process – Automate the interview scheduling	5 Hiring – Perform reference checks – If needed, do a background check – Support manager in making a data-driven decision	6 Onboarding – Stay in touch during pre-boarding – Check in regularly during onboarding – Inform hiring manager where necessary
--	--	--

Figure 2.9 Stages of the recruitment process

10 Topic 8: Orientation and Onboarding

Orientation

is the process of introducing new employees to the company, its culture, and their role in it. It is usually a one-day event that includes presentations from senior leaders, tours of facilities, and introductions of new colleagues.

Onboarding

is a more comprehensive process that helps new employees get ready and become productive members of the team. It usually lasts for several weeks or months and this process includes technical training on specific job duties and skills training on working with customers or suppliers as well as on company policies and procedures.

Logistics

One of the most important aspects of planning an orientation and onboarding program is logistics. They include:

1. Scheduling: When will the orientation and onboarding sessions be held? How long will it be?
2. Site: Where will the sessions be held? Will they be in-person or virtual?
3. Materials: What materials will new employees need, such as employee handbooks, training manuals, and name badges?
4. Food and beverages: Will food and beverages be provided? If so, what type?

Defining Culture Awareness

Another important aspect of orientation and onboarding is introducing new employees to the company culture. This includes:

Mission, vision and values:

What are the company's mission and vision?

History:

What is the company's history? How did it start?

Culture:

What is the company's culture? What are the company's values?

Products:

What are the company's most prominent products/services and the most suitable method to work with those products and market them to customers?

Training/Facilitation

Orientation & onboarding should also include opportunities for new employees to learn and grow. This includes:

Job-specific training:

New employees should receive training on the specific duties of their job. This training should be tailored to their individual needs and experiences.

Company-wide training:

New employees should also receive training on company policies and procedures. This training is supposed to help them understand the company's expectations and become productive members of the team.

Here are some tips for planning and implementing a successful orientation and onboarding program:

Start early:

It is better to start planning the orientation and onboarding program early. This will give the employer enough time to make sure everything is well organized and all the necessary materials are in place.

Involve stakeholders:

Get input from various stakeholders, such as senior leaders, HR professionals, and new employees themselves. This will help to develop a program that meets everyone's needs.

Tailor the program to fit your company:

The orientation and onboarding program should be tailored to the company's culture and specific needs. There is no one-size-fits-all approach.

Use a variety of learning styles:

Keep in mind that new employees may learn in different ways. So, use a variety of learning methods, such as lectures, hands-on training, and simulations.

Provide feedback and support:

New employees need regular feedback and support. Make sure to communicate with them regularly and provide them with the resources they need to succeed.

Orientation and onboarding are essential to the success of new employees. By taking the time to plan and implement a successful program, you can help new employees reach success quickly and become productive members of the team.

Comparison	Orientation	Onboarding
Definition	Orientation is the first step in the onboarding process. This typically occurs on an employee's first day and provides an overview of the company, its culture, and policies.	Process of integrating new employee into company's culture & helping them succeed in career. It typically includes a variety of activities and events, such as job-specific training, team building exercises, mentorship programs, and social events.
The length of the period	Usually lasts one day or less.	Can last for several weeks or months
Objectives	The goal of orientation is to familiarize new employees with the company and its culture.	To help new employees succeed in their role by integrating them into the company culture and providing them with the resources they need.
Who is responsible?	Usually led by human resources.	HR, the direct manager, and it is possible to integrate other departments of the organization such as marketing and logistics
What is done?	Orientation typically covers topics such as the company's history and mission, values, organizational structure, employee benefits, harassment and discrimination policies, safety procedures, and employee handbook.	Job-specific training, team building, providing basic needs such as equipment and an office, introducing work procedures, and introducing the most important colleagues and clients
What is the result?	The result of orientation is that new employees have a basic understanding of the company and its culture.	The result of onboarding is that new employees are able to perform their jobs effectively and participate in their work.

11 Review Questions on Module 2

Q1. What is the purpose of scheduling orientation and onboarding sessions?

- A. Ensure that new employees have sufficient time to attend all sessions
- B. Ensure that sessions are neither too long nor too short
- C. Both (A) and (B)
- D. None of the above

Q2. Which of the following is not taken into account when forecasting future workforce needs?

- A. Company culture
- B. Technological progress
- C. Changes in market demand
- D. Attrition rates

Q3. What is the most important thing to consider when planning orientation & onboarding program?

- A. Location
- B. Schedule
- C. Material
- D. Foods and drinks

Q4. What is one thing employers should not do during the onboarding process?

- A. Provide new employees with clear expectations and goals
- B. Assign a mentor or friend to new employees
- C. Let new employees find their own way for themselves
- D. Provide regular feedback and support to new employees

Q5. What is the most important thing to include in a job ad?

- A. Job title
- B. Job description
- C. Required qualifications
- D. Salary range

Q6. What should you do before posting a job ad?

- A. Review it well and confirm the elements of the advertisement

- B. Have it reviewed by the relevant job manager and the Human Resources Department
 - C. Choose an appropriate means of dissemination to reach potential candidates
 - D. All of the above
-

Q7. What information should a job application include?

- A. Job title, department, job description, required qualifications, salary range, and start date
 - B. Job title, department, manager contact information, and budget
 - C. Job title, department, job description and required qualifications
 - D. Job title, department and start date
-

Q8. Who usually completes the job application approval and application?

- A. New employee
 - B. The manager
 - C. Hiring manager
 - D. Human resources
-

Q9. Which of the following is not a legitimate reason to conduct a background check on a job applicant?

- A. To check their criminal history
 - B. To verify their employment history
 - C. To check their social media accounts
 - D. To verify the academic degrees they have obtained
-

Q10. Which of the following recruitment sources is most effective for recruiting senior or specialized roles?

- A. Employee nominations
 - B. Social networks/social media
 - C. Employment agencies
 - D. Company website
-

Q11. Which of the following recruitment sources is most effective for recruiting a large number of candidates in a short period of time?

- A. Employee referral
 - B. Company website
 - C. Job advertisements
 - D. Job fairs
-

Q12. Which of the following is a disadvantage of employee referral as a recruitment source?

- A. It can lead to bias
 - B. Not a good fit for the company culture
 - C. Less rapid hiring process
 - D. More expensive hiring process
-

Q13. Which of the following is an advantage of social media as source of recruitment?

- A. A large pool of candidates
 - B. A diverse audience
 - C. Cost effective
 - D. All of the above
-

Q14. Which of the following is not a benefit of alternative staffing practices for employees?

- A. Increased flexibility
 - B. Higher pay
 - C. More job security
 - D. The opportunity to work on a variety of projects
-

Q15. Which of the following is not a type of contractual work?

- A. Temporary workers until hired
 - B. Permanent work
 - C. Self-employment
 - D. Advisors
-

Q16. Which of the following interviewing techniques is most appropriate for large-scale hiring?

- A. Structured interviews
 - B. Unstructured interviews
 - C. Behavioral interview
 - D. Situational interview
-

Q17. What are the main advantages of job sharing for employees?

- A. Better work-life balance
 - B. More control over their work
-

- C. The opportunity to work on a variety of projects
- D. All of the above

Q18. Which of the following interviewing techniques is most likely to be intimidating to candidates?

- A. Structured interview
- B. Unstructured interview
- C. Behavioral interview
- D. Panel/Group interview

Q19. What is the purpose of the onboarding process?

- A. To help new employees get up and running quickly and easily
- B. Provide new employees with training and information about the company, job, and team
- C. Make new employees feel welcome and valued
- D. All of the above

Q20. Which of the following is not an essential step in the workforce planning process?

- A. Conduct market research
- B. Analyze the current situation of the workforce
- C. Forecasting future workforce needs
- D. Develop workforce strategies

Answers

Q	Answer	Interpretation
1	C	Scheduling orientation and onboarding sessions is important to ensure that new employees have enough time to attend all sessions and that the sessions are not too long or too short.
2	A	Company culture is an important factor in employee retention and satisfaction, but it is not usually a factor that directly impacts future workforce needs.
3	B	Scheduling is one of the most important things to consider when planning an orientation and onboarding program because it ensures that new employees have enough time to attend all sessions and that the sessions are neither too long nor too short.
4	C	The biggest mistake that employers make is letting the employee discover the company on his own. This leads to the new employee losing enthusiasm and desire to work.
5	B	The job description is the most important thing to include in a job advertisement because it tells potential candidates what the job is about and what responsibilities they will be expected to perform.

Q	Answer	Interpretation
6	D	It is important to review your job ad carefully before posting it to avoid any errors. It is also a good idea to have it reviewed by the relevant manager and human resources and be sure to post it where potential candidates can easily access it.
7	A	It is necessary that the employment application contain all the necessary information and necessary approvals, which are job title, department, job description, required qualifications, salary range, and start date.
8	B	Managers are usually responsible for identifying and requesting the hiring of new employees.
9	C	Employers must conduct background checks on job applicants only for legitimate reasons, such as verifying their employment history or verifying criminal convictions. Credit scores and social media accounts are not legitimate business reasons to run a background check.
10	C	Recruitment agencies have a network of contacts and expertise that can help employers find qualified candidates for high-level positions or specialist roles.
11	D	Job fairs are a great way to meet a large number of potential candidates in a short period of time. Employers can set up booths at career fairs and interview candidates on the spot.
12	A	Employee referrals can introduce bias if employees are more likely to nominate their friends and family members, even if they are not the most qualified candidate for the role.
13	D	Social networking/social media is a cost-effective way to reach a wide range of potential candidates, including the diversity of this audience.
14	C	Alternative employment practices are usually temporary in nature, so employees do not enjoy the same level of job security as permanent employees.
15	B	Permanent work is not a type of contract work. Contract work is usually temporary in nature, and the worker is hired for a specific period of time to work on a specific project.
16	A	Structured interviews are fair and objective, and allow employers to compare candidates on an equal footing. This makes it a good choice for large-scale hiring, where employers need to interview a large number of candidates in a short period of time.
17	D	Job sharing can provide employees with a better work-life balance, more control over their work, and the opportunity to work on a variety of projects.
18	D	Group interviews can be more intimidating for candidates than other types of interviews, because they involve interviewing a group of people at the same time.
19	D	The onboarding process is very important to help new employees get on the job quickly and easily, provide new employees with training and information about the company, the job, and the team, and at the same time make new employees feel welcome and appreciated.
20	A	Workforce planning focuses on internal workforce needs, while market research focuses on external market conditions.